

PERESKIA

are borne in fall only on plants over 3ft (1m) high. Cut back hard to main stems in fall. Z12 (min. 59°F/15°C)
P. grandifolia, syn. *Rhodocactus grandifolius* (Rose cactus), illus. p.485.

PERICALLIS

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of perennials and subshrubs, sometimes grown as annuals, especially for their daisylike flower heads. Often known as cinerarias. Frost tender. Requires sun or partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by seed sown from spring to midsummer.
P. x hybrida, syn. *Cineraria cruentus* of gardens, *C. x hybridus*, *Senecio cruentus*, *S. x hybridus* (Florist’s cineraria). H 18–24in (45–60cm), S 10–24in (25–60cm). Slow-growing, evergreen, mound- or dome-shaped perennial. Cultivars are grown as biennials. All have ovate, serrated, mid- to deep green leaves. Large, daisylike, single, semidouble or double flower heads, in shades of blue, red, pink or white, sometimes bicolored, are borne in winter or spring. Z10–12 (min. 45°F/7°C). **Jester Series** cultivars, H and S 8–10in (20–25cm), are compact, with flower heads in shades of blue, pink, scarlet, crimson, and carmine-red, sometimes with white eyes. **Senetti Series** cultivars bear blue, violet, or magenta flower heads, including some bicolored; tolerant of low temperatures. **Senetti Series SENETTI BLUE BICOLOR** (**‘Sunsemeribuba’**) illus. p.314.

PERILLA

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of annuals, grown for their aromatic foliage, often variegated or flushed red or bronze. Frost hardy. Grow in sun and in fertile, well-drained soil. Pinch out growing tips of young plants to encourage a bushy habit. Propagate by seed sown under glass in early spring.
P. frutescens. Vigorous, upright, bushy, hairy annual. H to 3ft (1m), S to 1ft (30cm). Has broadly ovate, pointed, serrated, aromatic, mid-green leaves, sometimes flecked purple. In summer, bears spikes of tiny, tubular, white flowers. Z9–11
P. ‘Magilla Vanilla’ illus. p.318.

PERIPLOCA

APOCYNACEAE/ASCLEPIADACEAE

Genus of deciduous or evergreen shrubs and twining climbers, grown for their attractive leaves. Stems exude milky juice if cut. Frost hardy. Grow in sun and in any well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer. ☉The fruits and sap may cause stomach upset if ingested.
P. graeca (Silk vine). Deciduous, twining climber. H to 28ft (9m). Ovate, glossy leaves are 1–2in (2.5–5cm) long. In summer, has clusters of 8–12 greenish-yellow flowers, purplish-brown inside, each with 5 lobes. Pairs of narrowly cylindrical seed pods, 5in (12cm) long, contain winged, tufted seeds. Scent of the flowers is thought by some to be unpleasant. Good for training on a pergola, trellis, or wires against a wall. Z9–11

PERISTROPHE

ACANTHACEAE

Genus of mainly evergreen perennials and subshrubs, grown usually for their flowers. Frost tender. Grow in a sunny or partially shaded position and in well-drained soil; do not overwater plants in winter. Propagate by stem cuttings in spring or summer.
P. angustifolia. See *P. hyssopifolia*.
P. hyssopifolia, syn. *P. angustifolia*. Evergreen, bushy perennial. H to 2ft (60cm), S 3–4ft (1–1.2m). Broadly lance-shaped leaves, with long-pointed tips, are 3in (8cm) long. Small clusters of tubular, deep rose-pink flowers open in winter. Z11–12 (min. 50°F/10°C). **‘Aureovariegata’** illus. p.476.

Pernettya. See *Gaultheria*.

PEROVSKIA

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of deciduous subshrubs, grown for their aromatic, gray-green foliage and blue flowers. Fully hardy. Requires a position in full sun and very well-drained soil. Cut plants back hard, almost to base, in spring, as new growth starts. Propagate by softwood cuttings in late spring.
P. atriplicifolia. Deciduous, upright subshrub. H 4ft (1.2m), S 3ft (1m). Gray-white stems bear narrowly ovate, coarsely toothed leaves. Produces 2-lipped, violet-blue flowers in long, slender spikes from late summer to mid-fall. H5
P. ‘Blue Spire’ illus. p.159.

PERSICARIA

SYN. ACONOGONON, BISTORTA, TOVARA
notweed

POLYGONACEAE

Genus of annuals, sometimes invasive perennials and rarely evergreen, semievergreen, or deciduous subshrubs. Grown for their attractive fall leaf color and their spikes or panicles of small, usually long-lasting, white, pink, or red flowers. Fully hardy to half hardy. Requires sun or partial shade and moist soil. Propagate by seed in spring; divide perennials in spring or fall. ☉Contact with all parts may irritate skin; the sap may cause mild stomach upset if ingested.
P. alpina, syn. *P. polymorpha* (illus. p.234). Clump-forming, leafy perennial. H and S 6ft (2m) or more. Stout, branching stems bear large, elliptic- to lance-shaped, mid-green leaves. In midsummer, produces frothy, heads of tiny, long-lasting, creamy-white flowers at stem tips. Z3–8
P. affinis, syn. *Polygonum affine*. Mat-forming, evergreen perennial. H to 10in (25cm), S 2ft (60cm) or more. Stout stems bear small, lance-shaped, glossy, green leaves that turn red-bronze in winter. From midsummer to mid-fall, produces dense spikes of small, funnel-shaped, rose-red flowers, fading to pale pink. Good on a bank or in a rock garden. Z3–8. **‘Darjeeling Red’**, S 20in (50cm), has long spikes of deep red flowers. **‘Donald Lowndes’** illus. p.365.

‘Superba’ (illus. p.234) is vigorous and has pale pink flowers, becoming deep pinkish-red, with red sepals; leaves turn rich brown in fall.
P. amplexicaulis, syn. *Bistorta amplexicaulis*, *Polygonum amplexicaule*. Clump-forming, leafy perennial. H and S 4ft (1.2m). Has ovate to heart-shaped, mid-green leaves. Bears profuse spikes of small, rich red flowers from midsummer to early fall. Z4–7. **‘Alba’**, H 3ft (90cm), S 48in (120cm), has showy spikes of white flowers. **‘Blotau’** see *P.a.* TAURUS.
‘Firetail’ (illus. p.234), H to 3–4ft (1–1.2m), S to 2ft (60cm), bears slender spikes of bright red flowers above heart-shaped leaves. **TAURUS** (**‘Blotau’**), H to 32in (80cm), S to 3ft (100cm), bears bright crimson-red flowers; is reputed to spread less than many other selections.
P. bistorta, syn. *Polygonum bistorta* (Bistort). **‘Superba’** (illus. p.234) is a vigorous, clump-forming, semievergreen perennial. H to 3ft (90cm), S to 2ft (60cm). Produces spikes of soft pink flowers above ovate leaves in summer. Z4–7
P. campanulata, syn. *Polygonum campanulatum* (illus. p.234). Compact, mat-forming perennial. H and S 3ft (90cm). Has ovate leaves, brown-felted beneath. Bears branching heads of bell-shaped, pink or white flowers from midsummer to early fall. Z5–8. **‘Rosenrot’** (illus. p.234), H 4ft (1.2m), S 3ft (1m), has reddish-pink flowers in summer.
P. capitata, syn. *Polygonum capitatum*. Compact, spreading perennial. H 3in (8cm), S 20in (50cm). Small, ovate leaves are green with darker marks. Small, round heads of pink flowers are borne in summer. Suitable for a rock garden or bank. Z9–11
P. macrophylla, syn. *Polygonum macrophyllum*, *Polygonum sphaerostachyum*, illus. p.265.
P. microcephala. Spreading, leafy, rhizomatous perennial. H to 2ft (60cm), S 3ft (1m) or more. Has lance-shaped, reddish-green leaves with darker zonal markings. Branching stems bear small, rounded heads of minute, white flowers in summer. Z6–8. **‘Red Dragon’** (syn. *P. ‘Red Dragon’*; illus. p.234), H to 4½ft (1.3m), has deep red leaves, each marked with a silvery chevron. Leaves develop greenish tints as they age.
P. polymorpha. See *P. alpina*.
P. milletii, syn. *Polygonum milletii*. Compact, semievergreen perennial. H and S 2ft (60cm). Narrow, lance-shaped leaves are mid-green. Produces slender spikes of rich crimson flowers from midsummer to early fall. Z8–11
P. ‘Red Dragon’. See *P. microcephala* **‘Red Dragon’**.
P. vacciniifolia, syn. *Polygonum vacciniifolium*, illus. p.373.
P. virginiana, syn. *Polygonum virginianum*, *Tovara virginiana*. Rather variable, clump-forming perennial. H to 4ft (1.2m), S 2– 4½ft (60–140cm). Ovate, pale green leaves have brownish-mauve blotches, brightest in spring. In late summer and early fall, bears spikes of tiny, green flowers. Z4–8. **‘Batwings’**, H and S to 32in (80cm), has narrowly ovate leaves with a dark red chevron mark. **var. filiformis** **‘Lance Corporal’** (illus. p.234), H and S to 32in (80cm), has

a rich brown chevron mark on each leaf. **‘Painter’s Palette’** (illus. p.234) has green leaves with central, brown zones, ivory-yellow splashes and stripes, and an overall deep pink tinge. Seldom flowers in cultivation.

PETASITES

Butterbur

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of rhizomatous perennials, grown for their usually large leaves and value as groundcover. Good for a wild garden or beside a stream or pool; can be invasive. Fully hardy to frost hardy. Tolerates sun or shade; prefers moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by division in spring or fall.
P. fragrans (Winter heliotrope). Spreading perennial. H to 1ft (30cm), S 5ft (1.5). Has basal, kidney-shaped, toothed, dark green leaves, on stalks to 1ft (30cm) long. Small, vanilla-scented, daisylike, pinkish-white flower heads are produced in late winter before foliage. Z8–10
P. japonicus. Spreading perennial. H 3½ft (1.1m), S 5ft (1.5). Has large, kidney-shaped, toothed, light green, basal leaves on stalks 3ft (1m) long. In early spring, bears dense cones of small, daisylike, yellowish-white flowers before leaves emerge. Z5–9

X PETCHOA

SOLANACEAE

Hybrids of *Calibrachoa* and *Petunia*, sometimes called calitunias. Trailing, free-flowering perennials, grown as annuals for their flowers in many colors. Frost tender. Requires full sun; grow as for *Petunia*. Good as summer bedding, and in hanging baskets and containers. Propagate by cuttings; does not set seed.
x P. SuperCal Series SUPERCAL NEON ROSE (**‘Kakegawa S89’**) illus. p.303.
x P. ‘Kakegawa S89’. See x *P. SuperCal Series SUPERCAL NEON ROSE*.

PETREA

VERBENACEAE

Genus of deciduous or semievergreen small trees, shrubs, and woody-stemmed, twining climbers, grown for their flowers. Frost tender. Needs full light and fertile, well-drained soil. Water regularly, less when not in full growth. Provide support. Thin out and spur back crowded growth in spring. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer. Mealy bug and whitefly may cause problems.
P. volubilis (Purple wreath, Queen’s wreath) illus. p.463.

PETROCOSMEA

GESNERIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, rhizomatous perennials. Frost tender. Needs shade and well-drained, peaty soil. Propagate by seed in early spring or by leaf cuttings in early summer.
P. kerrii illus. p.361.

Petrophyton. See *Petrophytum*.